Audit evidence transfer - operating guide

CURRENT 2026; effective 1 August 2026

Scope: Internal audit coordinators and controlled evidence rooms. This is fictional Meridian Works guidance. The following responsibilities apply only to the named activity, not to other procedures with similar labels.

Evidence owners share requested spreadsheets through the controlled evidence room rather than uncontrolled email attachments.

AUD-246 approves an evidence-room access extension; AUD-264 approves a finding-owner reassignment.

The coordinator records what actually happened, identifies the responsible owner and checks the applicable route. A similarly numbered form is not interchangeable with the recorded form. For a rejected submission, retain the original request and obtain corrected evidence rather than creating a replacement event.

Registry AUD-347: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-358: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-369: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-380: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Eligibility and operational limits. Select the named cohort and activity before applying a period or amount; different entitlements in this section are not substitutes.

External auditors receive read-only evidence rights; internal control testers may annotate evidence copies.

An evidence-room access extension can last fifteen calendar days before a fresh approval is required.

A valid request contains its underlying event date and the scope used for the calculation. Reviewers distinguish acknowledgement, completion and storage periods. A deadline for submitting evidence is not a service restoration promise. If the activity or group is not stated, escalate the question rather than borrowing a nearby rule.

Registry AUD-391: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-402: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-413: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry AUD-424: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Document control: this 2026 operating guide is CURRENT and effective from 1 August 2026. The 2024 edition is archived and superseded. No forecast for a later year is stated.

The audit procedure currently effective in 2026 permits a fifteen-calendar-day standard access extension.

Transfer controls define access and handling. Record lifetimes are set in the assurance records schedule.

The reference annex has its own scope. Staff should distinguish operational permission from commercial price, evidence retention and service specifications. Publication of a code or a process owner does not create a missing technical limit or a financial guarantee.

Amendment log: this edition consolidates the current timing rule and ownership path. Historical examples remain in the archive for traceability. They are not exceptions to the current rule. A request citing an older edition must be checked against the effective document before execution.